



IDS11074

Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Tuesday 21 July 2026
for the period until midnight CST Friday 24 July 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A trough crosses South Australia on Tuesday evening, followed by a series of weak cold fronts that cross the south of the State during Wednesday. A ridge of high pressure will build over the west of the State from later Wednesday, with the high centre expected to cross South Australia on Friday and Saturday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly in the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon and evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to southwesterly below 10 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: North to northwesterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: West to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly in the late morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southeast to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning west to southwesterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: West to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending south to southwesterly during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 21 July until midnight

Winds: Northwesterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 22 July

Winds: West to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 23 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres through the Backstairs Passage around midday. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 24 July

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres through the Backstairs Passage. Weather: Cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Tuesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.